3-DAY WORK-OUT GUIDE

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12-WEEK WORK-OUT ROUTINE

This is a **12-week program** where you will do the same exercises, 3 days per week, for the entire duration of the program. You should not "change-up" your workout unless you've reached a strength plateau, have a pre-existing injury, lacking equipment, equipment availability, or feeling unmotivated from doing the same workouts. Refer to the **Exercise Alternatives** chapter of the course to learn how to swap out exercises.

Below is a **3-day per week training template.** You are free to select any day of the week to do your workouts, provided you aim to get at least one day of rest between each workout. **Proper rest is just as important as proper training.**

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Push	*Rest*	**Pull**	*Rest*	**Legs**	*Rest*	*Rest*

Note: To get the most value from this training guide, you must refer to the course videos where you will learn essential knowledge that will assist your transformation journey. **Please don't skip these videos** where you'll learn how to progress in your workouts (linear and double progression), measuring and tracking progress, breaking through plateaus, managing your nutrition, and more.

PROGRAM GUIDELINES

(PLEASE READ CAREFULLY BEFORE STARTING THE PROGRAM)

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

The biggest mistake beginner's make is constantly changing-up their exercises when you need to be doing the exact opposite to see results. You must stick to a routine that focuses on the few compound movements that will give you the biggest bang for your buck. The aim of the game is to get very strong on the "Big 5." Refer to the **Training** chapter of the course to learn more about the Big 5.

Progressive overload is the north star around which all your workouts will be organised.

It's also the main reason why I recommend sticking with the same routine, same exercises, same rep ranges, and same exercise order for at least **12 weeks.**

If you're constantly changing up program variables, how are you going to consistently progress? You're not! Therefore, so many people get stuck spinning their wheels in the gym because they change things up too often. This was one of the biggest mistakes I made in the early days of my own training journey. *Don't make the same mistake!*

PUSH-PULL-LEGS ROUTINE

This 3-day per week workout routine is based off one of the most effective workout routines you can use to build muscle. Your major muscle groups are split into three different workouts—*push, pull, and legs.* In this routine, your "push" day will focus on **chest, shoulders, and triceps**. Your "pull" day will focus on **back, biceps, and rear delts.** And finally, your "leg" day focuses on your entire lower body—**quads, hamstrings and calves.** Ab-specific training is added to the end of your push-pull-legs routine.

DELOAD WEEK—EVERY 6 WEEKS

A de-load week will be needed at around 6 weeks into the program. It's a week of prioritising rest and recovery by reducing training volume to avoid the effects of overtraining and to recover from decreased energy levels, lifting plateaus, etc. You can either take a week off all weight training or reducing all *working set weight* by 50%. The choice is yours but regardless, **you must** consider a de-load week if you wish to continue making progress in this program. If you still do not feel reinvigorated after reducing the weights by 50% for one week then I suggest no weightlifting for five days before getting back into proper lifting again.

FINDING YOUR STARTING WEIGHT

The amount of weight you'll be lifting in this program is whatever weight that is necessary to operate within the desired rep range. For the Big 5, the rep range you'll be training within is 6 to 8 reps. By trial and error, you'll need to slowly add weight to the bar until you are hitting around 7 reps in a single set.

HOW TO PROGRESS ON THE PROGRAM?

You can correctly track your macros and calorie intake, focus on heavy compound lifting, and proper rest however, failing to add weight to the bar over time, would mean you would quickly plateau. Please watch the **Training** chapter of the course where I discuss how to use **linear progression** and **double progression** to get stronger over time.

Essentially, once you reach 8 reps for one set, it's time to add weight for the next set. I would increase the weight on the bar by 5 kg total (10 lbs)—or 2.5 kg (5 lbs) either side of the barbell. If you are using dumbbells, increase the dumbbell weight by 2.5 kg (5 lbs) each. Expect your rep count to drop by around 2 reps with every 5 kg increase in weight. If you increase the weight and you fall below 6 reps, slightly reduce the weight so that you are hitting a *minimum* of 6 reps per set.

Your primary objective is to try and lift slightly heavier than the previous week—even if it's just by a single rep! There will be some weeks where you'll only be lifting what you lifted in the previous week. This is normal. *Just keep going…*

HOW TO PERFORM THE WORKOUTS

You need to do the exercises in the order given. *Do not change the exercise order.* You'll start by doing the necessary warm-up sets, followed by *three heavy sets per exercise* (with proper rest between each set), then move to the next exercise on the list.

TRACKING YOUR LIFTING

One of the most crucial things you need to do is track your weightlifting progress every single workout. You will never know what weight to use or how many reps to perform for the next workout if you don't have a record of your previous workout. *This is the only way to know if you've improved from your previous workout.* It's vital—before stepping into the gym—that you know proactively what weight and number of reps you hope you achieve. **Remember:** never under-estimate small weekly gains in weight or reps—even if it's 2.5 kgs (5 lbs) for a lift or a single rep—it's an *improvement*. Small improvements grow to huge changes in your physique over time.

One of the easiest ways to track your progress is using the app called **FitNotes**—available for free for both iOS and Android. This is my personal favourite method and, at present, I have 7 years of recorded history that I can recall at the push of a button. Try it for yourself! Alternatively, use "notes" in your phone or a good old-fashioned notebook.

Watch the **Measuring Progress** chapter of the course to learn more about tracking your lifting progress.

HOW LONG DO MY SESSIONS NEED TO BE?

Each of your lifting sessions will be **60 to 70 minutes** (maximum). If your training sessions are longer than 70 minutes, then you are doing something wrong. I highly recommend timing your rest periods by either using your stopwatch or phone. FitNotes has a built-in timer that I use to track all my rest periods. Keep gym chat to a minimum to remain 100% focused on your workouts and can maintain proper mind-muscle connection during your workouts (see video **Mind-Muscle Connection**).

FIRST FEW WEEKS AS A BEGINNER

If you are an absolute beginner or very new to weightlifting—I'd suggest starting with a 3-day workout routine (this program) and if you are struggling to work within the 6- to 8-rep range, then for the first 3 to 4 weeks, work within the 8- to 10-rep range for all lifts.

As an absolute beginner, it's normal to struggle to maintain proper form on some of the exercises in the program. You'll likely experience intense muscle soreness and aches after some of your workouts, particularly after leg day. This is **totally normal** and as time passes, you'll experience less and less muscle soreness. ***Trust the process!***

If you are experiencing **sharp pains** while lifting then something is wrong with your technique. Immediately stop, reduce the weight and re-assess your technique before continuing. ***If you are experiencing any other serious pains during or after training, see a doctor or a physio.***

Let's get started...

WARM-UP ROUTINE

You only need to follow the warm-up routine **once** before the *first* exercise on the list.

This warm-up routine will help you tap into maximum strength without increasing the risk of injury. You'll introduce blood into the muscles to be trained and acclimate them to heavy weight without causing fatigue. By the end of this warm-up routine, your muscles will be ready for the muscle-building working sets.

Watch the **Training** chapter of the course to learn more about a proper warm-up routine. Refer to warm-up table below.

SET	WEIGHT	REPS	REST
1	50% working weight	10 - 12	60 Seconds
2	50% working weight	10 - 12	60 Seconds
3	70% working weight	4 - 5	60 Seconds
4	90% working weight	1 - 2	2 minutes
START WORKING SETS			

DAY 1

CHEST & SHOULDERS & TRICEPS & ABS

EXERCISE	WORKING SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)
START WITH WARM-UP SETS			
Incline Dumbbell Bench Press*	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Barbell Military Press** (Seated or Standing)—shoulders	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Flat Barbell Bench Press	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Rear Delt Dumbbell Raise	3	10 – 12	2
TRICEPS			
Tricep Dips	3	8 – 10	2
3 X AB CIRCUITS			

* Building a great chest starts with a focus on incline pressing more than anything else. Decline pressing is inferior to flat or incline press due to reduced range of motion causing less stimulation of the pec majors and clavicular pectoralis.

** After finishing Incline Dumbbell Bench Press, do another round of warm-up sets for Military Press.

DAY 2

BACK & BICEPS

EXERCISE	WORKING SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)
START WITH WARM-UP SETS			
Barbell Deadlift*	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Close-Grip Lat Pull-Down	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Dumbbell Row	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Body weight Pull-Ups**	3	AMRAP***	2
BICEPS			
Barbell Curl	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Hammer Curls	3	6 – 8	2 – 3

* You can swap for **Sumo Deadlift** or **Hex Bar Deadlift** due to low back issues. These are more "lower-back friendly" exercises.

** You can start *with machine*-assisted pull-ups or with resistance bands to build progression toward body-weight pull-ups.

*** AMRAP—*as many reps as possible!*

DAY 3

LEGS & CALVES & ABS

EXERCISE	WORKING SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)
START WITH WARM-UP SETS			
Barbell Back Squat*	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Leg Press	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
Romanian Deadlift	3	6 – 8	2 – 3
CALVES			
Standing Calf Raises	3	8 – 10	2
Seated Calf Raises	3	8 – 10	2
3 X AB CIRCUITS			

* You can swap for **Barbell Front Squats** if you wish. *Every* leg workout should start with either the back or front squat.

Push Exercises

Exercise	*Exercise Alternative*
Flat (or Inclined) Barbell Bench Press	• Flat Dumbbell Bench Press • Inclined Dumbbell Bench Press • Machine Chest Press (Seated) • Flat (or Inclined) Smith Machine • Hammer Press • Chest Dips
Flat (or Inclined) Dumbbell Bench Press	• Flat Barbell Bench Press • Inclined Barbell Bench Press • Machine Chest Press (Seated) • Flat (or Inclined) Smith Machine • Hammer Press • Chest Dips
Close-Grip Bench Press	• Dips • Barbell J.M Press
Standing Barbell Overhead Press	• Dumbbell Shoulder Press • Seated Barbell Shoulder Press • Seated Smith Machine Overhead Press • Arnold Dumbbell Press • Landmine Press • Kettlebell Press
Dumbbell Side Lateral Raises	• Lean-away Cable Lateral Raise • Cable Side Lateral Raise
Triceps Push-Down (V-Bar, Rope, Straight Bar)	• Skull Crushers • Seated Triceps Press • Incline Dumbbell Kickbacks • Incline Dumbbell Overhead Extension • Standing Overhead Dumbbell Extension • Weighted Triceps Dip • Close-Grip Bench Press

Pull Exercises

Exercise	*Exercise Alternative*
Barbell Deadlift	• Dumbbell Deadlift • Deficit Deadlift • Rack Pulls • Trap-bar Deadlift • Sumo Deadlift • Romanian Deadlift • Stiff-legged Deadlift • Glute-ham Raise • Hyperextensions
Bent-Over One-Arm Dumbbell Row	• Chest-Supported Row (Seated) • T-Bar Row • Seated Cable Row • Pendlay Row • Yates Row • Barbell (or Dumbbell) Seal Row
Barbell Row	• Seated Cable Row • Helms Row • Yates Row • Seal Row
Pull-Ups	• Chin-Ups • Band-Assisted Pull-Ups • Lateral Pull-Down • Scapular Pull-Ups • Negative Pull-Ups • Assisted Pull-Up Machine • Renegade Rows
Face-Pulls	• Reverse Pec Deck Machine • Bent-Over Rear Delt Fly • Band Pull-Aparts • Chest-Supported T-Bar Rows • Inverted Rows
Barbell Curl	• EZ-Bar Preacher Curl • Dumbbell Preacher Curl • Cable Curl • Alternating Dumbbell Curl • Dumbbell Hammer Curl

Lower Body Exercises

Exercise	*Exercise Alternative*
Barbell Back Squats	• Barbell Front Squat • Dumbbell Goblet Squat • Dumbbell Step-Ups • Hack Squats • Zircher Squat • Reverse/Forward Lunges • Walking Lunges • Box Squats • Safety Bar Squat • Pistol Squats (Single Leg) • Bulgarian Split Squats
Standing (or Seated) Calf Raises	• Calf Press on Leg Press Machine • Calf Raises on Smith Machine • Donkey Calf Raises
Bulgarian Split Squats	• Dumbbell Lunge (Walking or in-place) • Barbell Lunge (in-place) • Single Leg Split Squat
Leg Press	• Barbell Back Squat with heels elevated (place 2x 5lb plates under heels) • Barbell Front Squat • Safety Bar Squat • Hack Squat • Goblet Squat • Pit Shark Belt Squat • Zircher Squat